

TV SHOW

Norsemen

★★★★☆ | Let's start off by saying that this show is adult humour and isn't meant for kids. The dysfunctional Viking warriors of Norheim are back for yet another season of Norsemen. Seasons 1 and 2 were centered around Jarl Varg's nefarious machinations towards obtaining the 'Map to the West' which would beget untold riches upon the rather ambitious Jarl Varg. In a sad twist of irony, the 'Map to the West' turns out to be ... well, a map to the west. All you had to do was sail due west and avoid the big serpent and you'd reach the shores of England. The two seasons left little scope for another season as the entire storyline was laid out by the end of Season 2. So for Season 3 we get a prequel and we get to know more about how the "Map to the West" came to be and how Orm ended up being the butt of all jokes.



More importantly, we're shown the transformation of Jarl Varg, who believe it or not, was once a benevolent Jarl (benevolent being a subjective assessment given that these are Vikings that we speak of) with a beautiful and loving wife and an equally devoted right-hand man, Torstein Hund. The cause of his violent transformation,

a rather benign remark that crushed his ego and, in his words, set about a "stress reaction" that led to him transforming into the psychopathic war-monger that we are familiar with.

Norsemen retains the delicate balance between comedy and drama that feels as if you're watching a period drama such as Vikings with humorous elements that are a juxtaposition of illogical reasoning, non-sequiturs and just plain utter nonsense. There are plenty of meta jokes which tie into events from the previous seasons, some of which serve as foreshadowings or misfortunes. The season ends up spinning entirely new story arcs, some of which are seen through to the end within the season itself but the show leaves plenty of open arcs to warrant another season. We wouldn't say that Season 3 outdid the previous seasons, production quality did certainly go up but the show had more drama and a little less humour that what we'd have preferred. The season starts off with a bang and then wanes towards mid-season before finally ramping up to a fitting and memorable end.

COMIC

Star Wars

★★★★☆ | Despite the schism in the fandom, Star Wars fans are having a great time thanks to a steady stream of content that everyone can agree is top notch. The latest is a new line of comics simply called Star Wars, which starts off at the ending of the fifth movie, just after Darth Vader cuts off Luke Skywalker's arm in Bespin. Boba Fett is zooming away with the Han frozen in Carbonite. Chewie, Luke, Lando and Leia, unlikely companions must make the plans for their next move.

First of all, we simply love the setting, as it is a visual treat to see the familiar environments and people of the well loved original trilogy in a modern comic form. The intricacies of the original sets are captured perfectly. The story does falter a bit in the telling after an action packed start, with C3PO relegated to the



undignified role of the comic relief. The deep connection that had been established between Lando and the Millennium Falcon in Solo also seems to be missing. However, the expressions of the original cast are captured in a priceless and novel manner, and the comic reads

almost like a storyboard for a movie that never saw the light of the day.

Both Darth Vader and Luke Skywalker channel the lessons of Jedi Master Yoda, and it is interesting to see two of his padawans, father and son, finding ways to outmanoeuvre each other using the same teachings. Bear in mind that this is at the crucial stage where Luke has just discovered who his father is. There are also some easter eggs that long time fans will spot, and certain connections made to the sequel trilogy as well. The story is far from fan service or a cash grab, and manages to be bold and original. Like the final season of Clone Wars, the story takes place right in the middle of events that we have already seen on screen, which just dials up the anticipation up to eleven, because the readers know exactly what is coming, but not about the complications encountered by the heroes on the way to those points in the story. It is a satisfying exploration into a crucial period that in hindsight, we should have seen more of.